Waite in *Commissioners* v. *Sellew*, 99 U. S. 624, 627, where a peremptory mandamus was directed against a municipal board: "As the corporation can only act through its agents, the courts will operate upon the agents through the corporation. When a copy of the writ which has been ordered is served upon the clerk of the board, it will be served on the corporation, and be equivalent to a command that the persons who may be members of the board shall do what is required. If the members fail to obey, those guilty of disobedience may, if necessary, be punished for the contempt. Although the command is in form to the board, it may be enforced against those through whom alone it can be obeyed. . . . While the board is proceeded against in its corporate capacity, the individual members are punished in their natural capacities for failure to do what the law requires of them as the representatives of the corporation." See also *Leavenworth* v. *Kinney*, 154 U. S. 642; *People* v. *Sturtevant*, 9 N. Y. 277.

The appellant asserts his privilege against self-crimination. There is no question, of course, of oral testimony, for he was not required to give any. Undoubtedly it also protected him against the compulsory production of his private books and papers. *Boyd* v. *United States, supra; Bollman* v. *Fagin*, 200 U. S. 195. But did it extend to the corporate books?

For there can be no question of the character of the books here called for. They were described in the subpœna as the books of the corporation, and it was the books so defined which, admitting possession, he withheld. The copies of letters written by the president of the corporation in the course of its transactions were as much a part of its documentary property, subject to its control and to its duty to produce when lawfully required in judicial proceedings, as its ledgers and minute books. It was said in the appellant's statement before the grand jury that the books contained copies of his "personal